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Best Robot Vacuums 2026: Roomba vs Shark Comparison Guide

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Your floors—cleaned while you live.

Coming home to dust, pet hair, and the never-ending cycle of manual vacuuming drains your time and energy. You need a cleaner you can trust to work reliably, fit your budget, and handle the mess your home actually creates.

The 2026 showdown between the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo and the Shark AI Ultra puts the features you care about—suction, mopping, self-emptying—to the test.

Proof: Below, we break down real-world performance, navigation smarts, and long-term value so you can match a model to your home's specific needs.

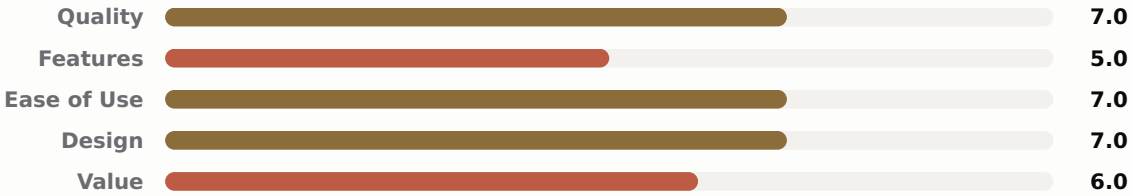
Action: Ready to choose? Jump to our comparison table or keep reading for a side-by-side deep dive, and use our affiliate links to grab your pick with confidence.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Robot Vacuum Comparison 2026: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo vs Shark AI Ultra

Why this comparison matters

Choosing a robot vacuum in 2026 isn't just about specs—it's about reclaiming your time and keeping your home clean with minimal effort. Between the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo's all-in-one mopping and auto-emptying convenience and the Shark AI Ultra's laser-precision at a lower price, the right choice hinges on your floor type, pet situation, and budget. This guide cuts through the marketing so you can decide with confidence.

Key features at a glance

Model	Price (checked Oct 04, 2026)	Suction Power	Mopping	Navigation Tech	AutoEmpty Dock	Battery Life	Smart-Home Compatibility
iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	$199.99 (was $469.99)	≈2,000 Pa	Vibrating mopping pad, 0.3 L water tank	iRobot vSLAM with camera-based mapping	Yes – holds up to 60 days of debris	≈90 min runtime, 3 h recharge	Alexa, Google Assistant, iRobot Home app
iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop (no dock)	$139.99 (was $319.99)	≈2,000 Pa	Vibrating mopping pad, 0.3 L water tank	iRobot vSLAM	No – standard 0.5 L dustbin	≈90 min runtime, 3 h recharge	Alexa, Google Assistant, iRobot Home app
		≈2,700 Pa	No mopping (vacuum-only)	Shark AI Laser Vision with	Yes – Self-Empty	≈120 min runtime,	Alexa, Google Assistant,

Model	Price (checked Oct 04, 2026)	Suction Power	Mopping	Navigation Tech	AutoEmpty Dock	Battery Life	Smart-Home Compatibility
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99 (was $599.00)			LiDAR-based mapping	Base holds up to 30 days	2.5 h recharge	SharkClean app
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99 (was $429.00)	≈2,700 Pa	No mopping	Shark AI Laser Vision	Yes – Self-Empty Base	≈120 min runtime, 2.5 h recharge	Alexa, Google Assistant, SharkClean app

Use this table to quickly match features to your priorities—suction for pet hair, mopping for hard floors, dock capacity for hands-free maintenance.

Cleaning performance on different floor types

Floor type is the fastest dealbreaker. On low-pile carpet, the Roomba's ≈2,000 Pa pulls embedded hair effectively, though the Shark's stronger ≈2,700 Pa offers more oomph for thick rugs. Hardwood and tile both benefit from the Roomba's mopping pad, which lifts light spills without leaving wet residue. If pet hair is your primary pain point, the Shark's high suction and tangle-resistant brush roll often win out in user reports.

Navigation and smart-home fit

Navigation tech dictates how thoroughly each room gets cleaned. The Roomba uses iRobot's vSLAM with camera-based mapping, which adapts well to layout changes but can be slower to initialize. The Shark AI Ultra employs Shark AI Laser Vision with LiDAR, mapping rooms quickly and avoiding obstacles with consistent accuracy. Both integrate with Alexa and Google Assistant, so your existing smart-home ecosystem won't dictate the switch.

Budget and long-term value

Price often seals the deal. The Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock lists at $199.99 (down from $469.99), positioning it as a premium all-rounder. The Shark AI Ultra sits at $249.99 (down from $599.00), offering stronger suction for less money if mopping isn't a priority. Factor in long-term costs: the Roomba's dock holds debris for 60 days versus the Shark's 30-day cycle, potentially saving you more replacement bags over time.

Action: Match your top priority—mopping, suction, or self-emptying—to the model that leads in that category, then click through to today's pricing using our affiliate link for the Roomba or affiliate link for the Shark. Your floors (and your schedule) will thank you.